Custom settings provide the easiest way to extend the application configuration. Using JSON as a storage format enables you to store complex information easily. This makes appSettings the perfect place to store mail server configuration information, for example. To illustrate this, you will extend the `ProductionEmailService`, so it uses MailKit to send mail. To do this, MailKit needs to know which mail server to connect to and on which port. It also needs to pass any credentials if the server requires authentication. You could include this configuration information within the `SendEmailAsync` method, but if you need to make changes to use a different server or credentials, for example, you must recompile the application. So you will store this information in a custom section within appSettings.json. Then if you need to make changes at a later date, you simply redeploy the updated version of the appSettings.json file.

Listing 14.10 shows the full version of your modified appSettings.json file. It contains a new section named `SmtpSettings`, which has a number of properties that represent the various values needed for configuring the mail server.

Listing 14.10 A custom appSettings.json section for mail server configuration

```
{
  "AllowedHosts": "*",
  "ConnectionStrings": {
    "CityBreaksContext": "Data source=Data/CityBreaks.db"
  },
  "SmtpSettings": {                    ❶
    "Host": "smtp.myprovider.com",     ❷
    "Port": "587",                     ❷
    "StartTls": "true",                ❷
    "Credentials": {                   ❷
      "UserName": "mike",              ❸
      "Password": "Shh!-s3cret#"       ❸
    }
```